2024? Will it undo the damage done to institutions and on the policy front over the past ten years? Or will it reach a compromise with the new situation it will encounter? These are grave doubts that the Congress will have to address at some point. Common people and social activists will have to be convinced that it will not be business as usual. The current polarized situation will create new challenges in governance. It cannot be based on routinized modalities. This is where the Congress's organizations will have to play a more coordinated role. In a polarized context, the Congress has to emerge as the default choice of those in disagreement with the current situation. This cannot happen unless Congress organizations look more trustworthy and ideologically oriented. It will further require ideology to be converted into common people's cultural idiom.

Finally, 2024 will be different because it calls for work round the clock and not six months before the elections. For this the Congress needs a cadre prepared for such ordeals. The BJY has created just the right conditions for such a transition, but it will not happen on its own. This transition cannot happen by 2024, but setting things in motion too will have a great impact. Civility, respect for institutions and being dialogic and prepared to accept criticisms have been the long-standing strengths of the Congress party. It is this latent strength that stands in contrast to right-wing hubris, and this will offer an opening to connect to a more activist-oriented aptitude.

The current challenge cannot be met with wheeler-dealer networks. This situation demands those who can work before thinking of rewards. The BJY and Rahul Gandhi's persona have inspired some degree of trust in this direction. There seems ample scope to recruit new voices that can transform the organizations that work independently and beyond electoral calculations. Elections will have to be seen as an extension and connected to constructive work, and not as an end in itself. The BJY has also brought in the ethic of listening and learning, which should translate to a constant critical feedback mechanism. For this, various levels of functioning will have to find a purpose at their own level of working, rather than look up for validation. These experiments could well be on the agenda for BJY 2.0.